

* DRAW YOUR FUTURE *

Case Study

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DES 157B

* OVERVIEW *

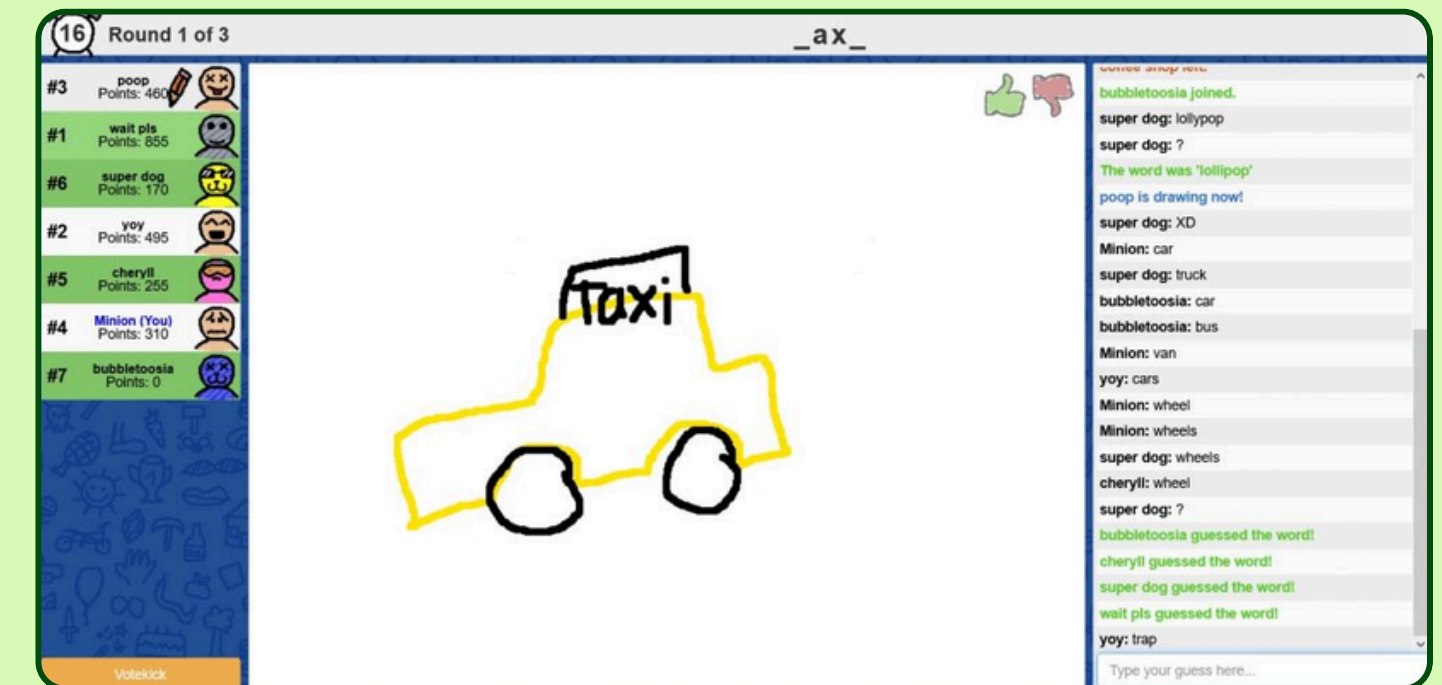
The future is scary. Thinking about the future is even scarier. When tasked with creating a future-based interactive project, I wanted to create an organic way to spark conversations about the future. As a designer and artist, I was drawn to the freedom of expression that creativity allows, so I decided to create a project that would invite people to share their own vision of the future.

Draw Your Future is an interactive drawing project that invites users to imagine and illustrate what the future might look like. The project is designed as a playful but reflective creative tool, combining drawing, prompts, and a gallery upload system so people can share their ideas with others, making future thinking feel accessible, personal, and non-intimidating.

* UX RESEARCH *

For my UX research, I looked at Skribbl.io and Flickgame.org, paying close attention to their interfaces.

Skribbl.io showed me how quickly a user can be pulled into a drawing experience with immediate prompting and gamification. Flickgame was especially useful because its interface is extremely minimal, which made me think about how simple icons can create an effective tool system without distracting from the user's creation.



* UX RESEARCH *

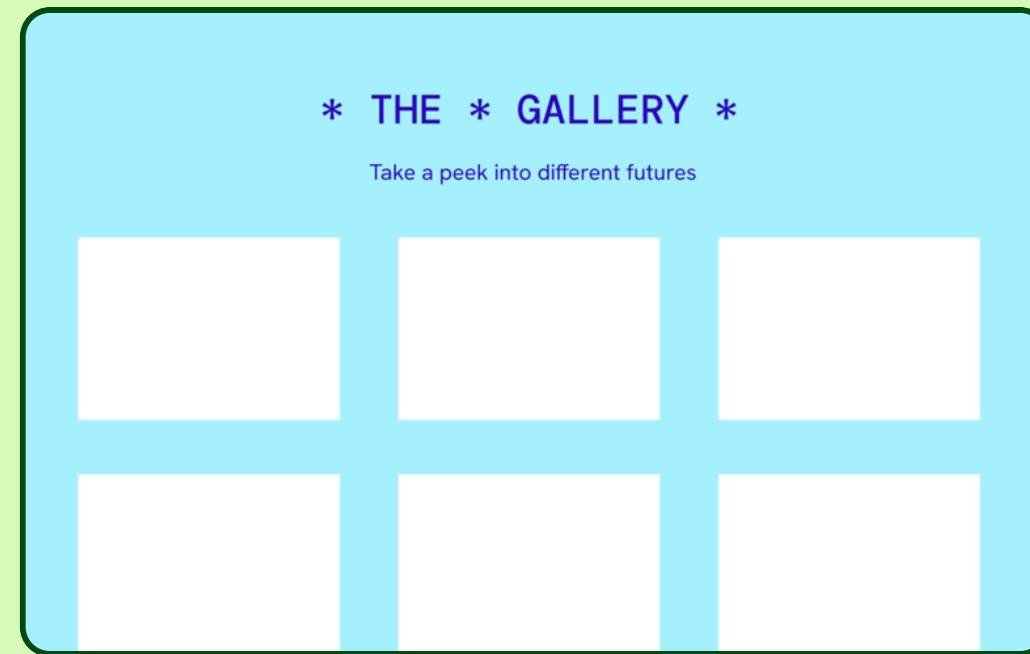
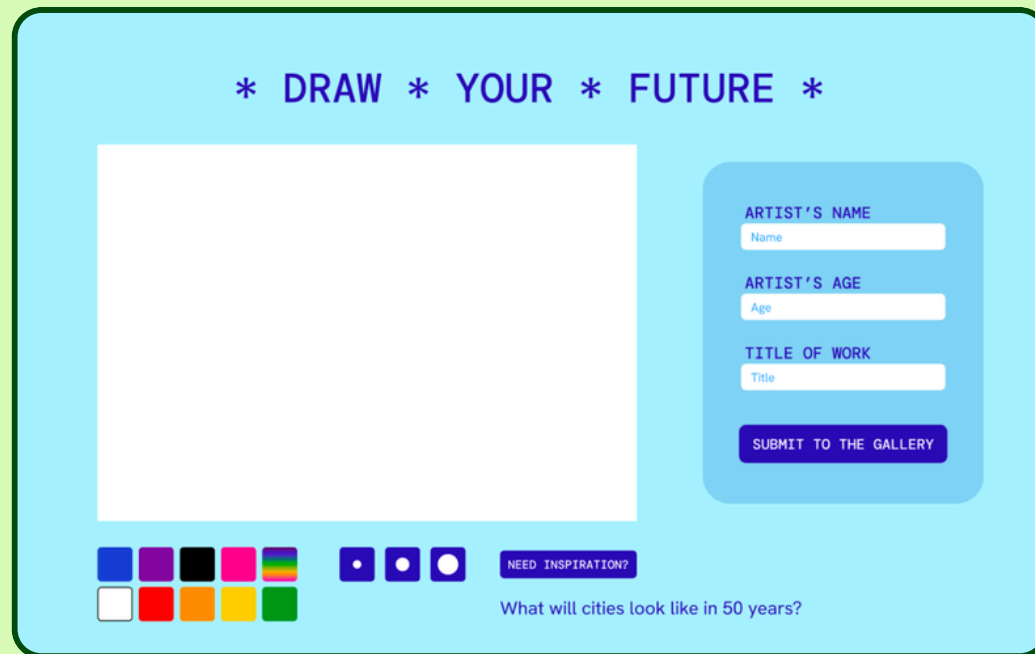
What I learned from these examples was that creative interfaces work best when they **reduce friction**.

Skribbli.io made me think about speed and clarity, while Flickgame made me think about simplicity and effective icon design. That changed my project direction from “add more features” to “make the essential tools obvious and familiar.”

This research helped me decide to keep my interface centered on a few core actions: choose a color, select a brush, erase, fill, save, and get a prompt.

Instead of building something that felt like a technical art program, I wanted to create a playful environment where users could start drawing right away and stay focused on their ideas.

* VISUAL DEVELOPMENT *



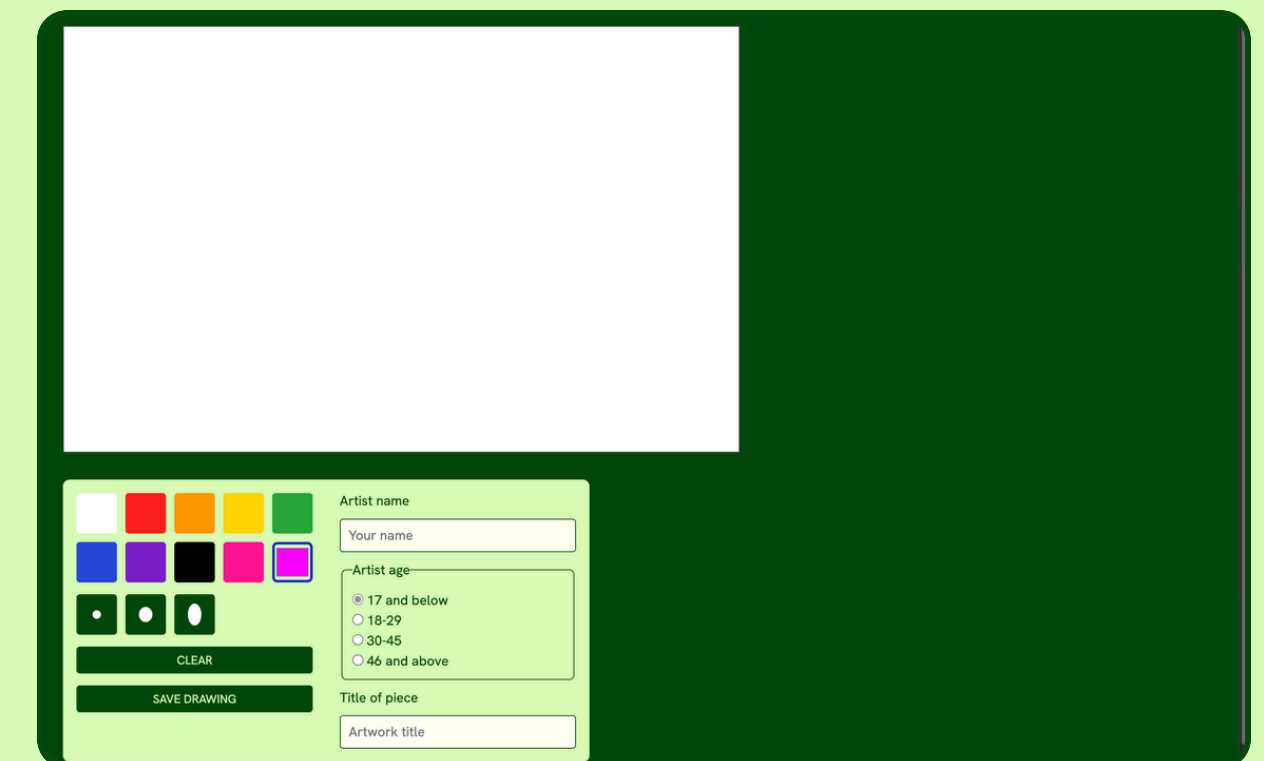
I knew the flow of the project from the start: prompt, draw, submit, observe. I wanted the drawing and gallery interfaces to be visually cohesive and simple, to let the art shine.

My initial wireframes used a monochromatic blue palette and a simple type system, both of which felt simultaneously futuristic and playful.

* VERSION 1 *

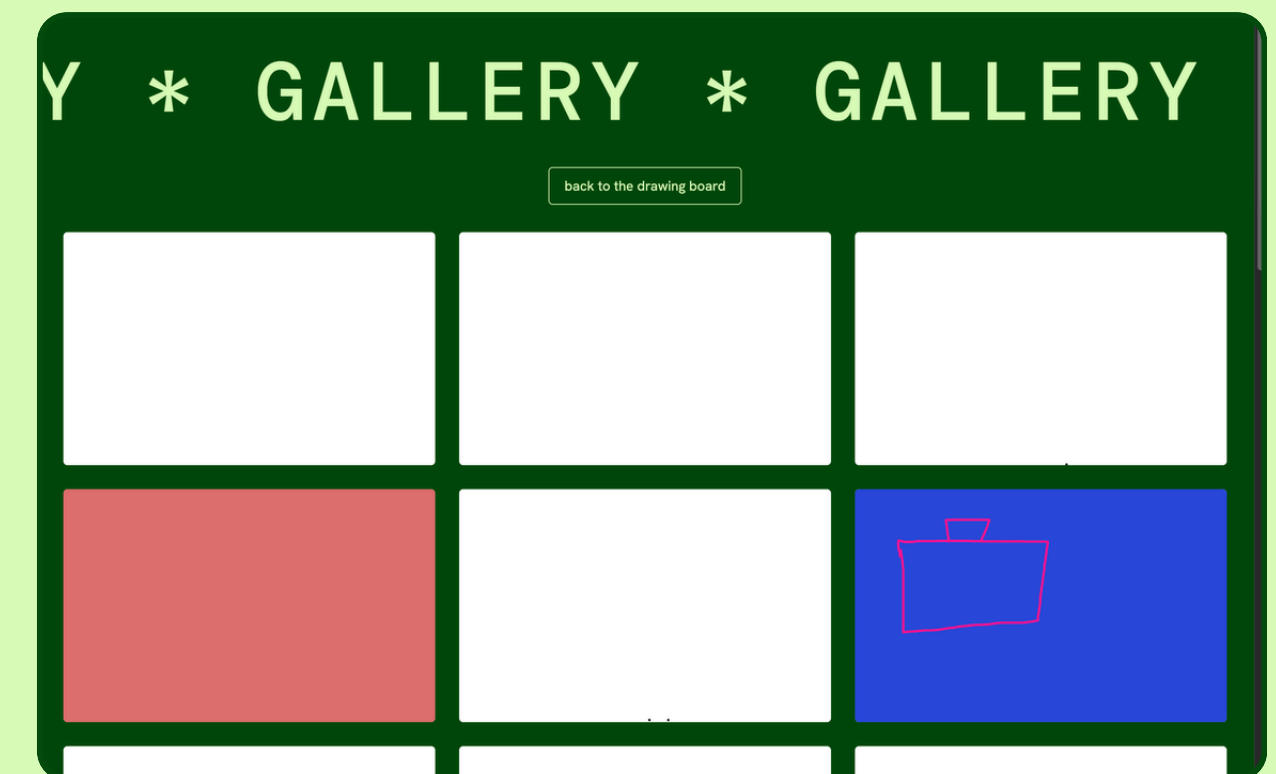
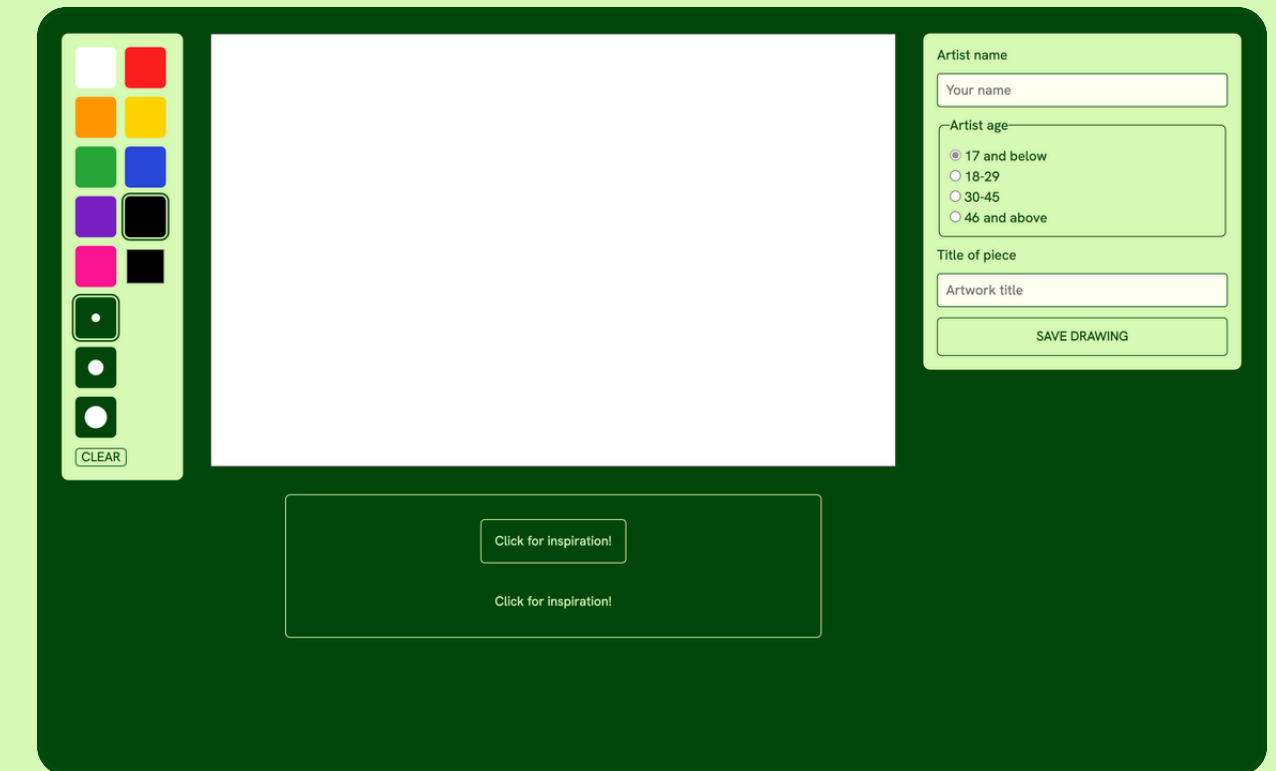
There was a big visual jump between my initial sketches and version 1 of the code. I wanted to make the project more experiential and immersive to inspire creativity, so I created a title screen. I shifted from a blue to a green palette to move away from cliché color associations with the future and make the interface feel more unique.

The interface in this version was less developed, as I was primarily concerned with figuring out how to capture users' drawings and upload them to the backend service I was using.



* VERSION 2 *

In version 2, I resolved a lot of the visual details of the drawing interface, and added in the prompting section. Separating the tools from the form with the canvas in the center was the biggest improvement at this stage; it made the interface more organized and separated the creative process from the data input. The layout helps reduce cognitive load because users do not have to hunt around the page to understand where actions happen. This was the version I submitted for usability testing.



* REVISIONS *

Usability testing revealed a few important areas where the project could be made more intuitive and better aligned with its concept.

The project needed clearer framing.

Several users drew freely instead of responding to the future-focused concept, which showed me that the site needed a stronger call-to-action.

The drawing tools needed to feel complete and familiar.

Users expected an eraser, a paint bucket, and clearer custom color controls, which sent me back to studying online drawing interfaces and designing tools that were easier to recognize.

The gallery needed better navigation and interactivity.

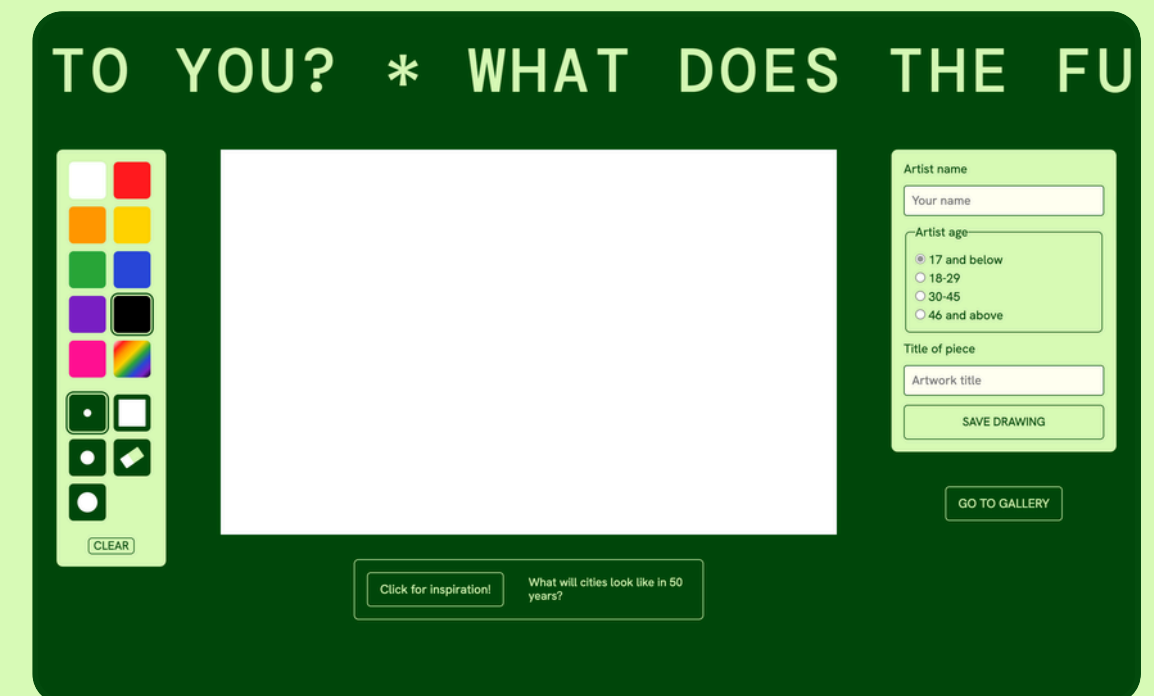
Users wanted to browse the gallery without submitting first, which showed me that the gallery should function as a place to explore, not just a page that stores submissions.

* FINAL VERSION *

Responding to the feedback I received in usability testing, I updated the tools panel to add more intuitive styling to the color picker, create an eraser tool, and a fill tool.

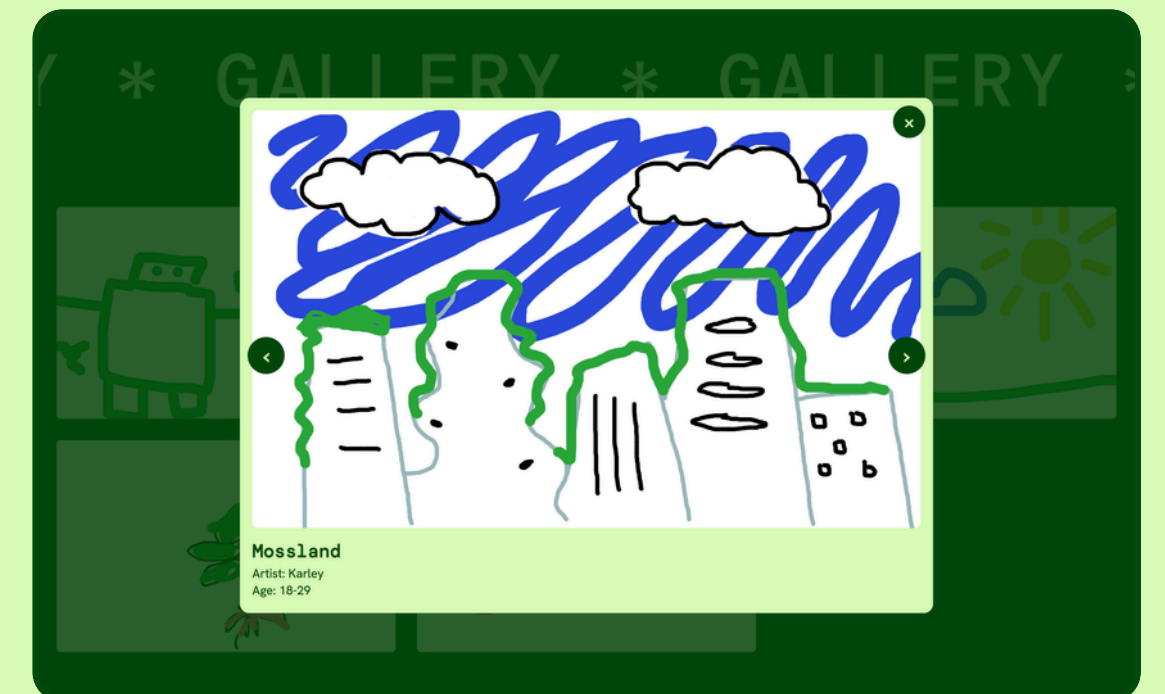
To avoid the “free draw” issue I ran into, I added a marquee heading consistent with the title and gallery pages that asks “What does the future look like to you?” to better direct users.

I created a button that takes users directly to the gallery for further inspiration, and to give them the option to explore the gallery without submitting a piece of their own.



* FINAL VERSION *

After usability testing, I refined the gallery experience to make it feel more open and interactive. I cleared out the test drawings I had been submitting so the gallery would be ready for the project's publication, and I added hover states to the gallery drawings that change the cursor to a pointer and slightly enlarge each image. These small interactions encourage users to click on the drawings and reveal the artist placards, which I designed using the information they input when submitting their work.



* SUMMARY *

Working on Draw Your Future taught me how powerful simple, open-ended creative tools can be when they are paired with clear structure. I learned that users are more willing to engage with a project when the interface feels approachable, the prompts are understandable, and the experience leaves room for personal interpretation.

What I am most proud of is how the project turned into both a playful drawing space and a thoughtful reflection on the future. The most challenging part was making the tools and navigation intuitive while still keeping the project visually engaging, but that challenge was also the most rewarding part because it helped me refine the experience into something more polished and user-friendly.

 **THANK YOU!** 

let's connect!

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